

6.4.11 Software Disposal Process

The Software Disposal Process in this International Standard is a specialization of the **Disposal Process** in ISO/IEC 15288. Users may consider claiming conformance to either the ISO/IEC 15288 process or this subclause (6.4.11).

6.4.11.1 Purpose

The purpose of the Software Disposal Process is to end the use of a system's software entity in a controlled manner, ensuring that software, data, and supporting documentation are retired responsibly while preserving organizational integrity and stakeholder trust.

NOTE: Disposal must consider organizational operations, long-term impacts, and societal obligations such as health, safety, security, privacy, and environmental protection.

6.4.11.2 Outcomes

As a result of successful implementation of the Software Disposal Process:

- a) A software disposal strategy is defined.
 - b) Disposal constraints are identified and provided as inputs to requirements for planning and execution.
 - c) System software elements are destroyed, archived, or otherwise stored in accordance with organizational and regulatory requirements.
 - d) The target environment is restored to an agreed-upon state after software removal.
 - e) Records of disposal actions, including long-term impact analysis, are created and preserved for compliance, auditing, and organizational learning.
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6.4.11.3 Activities and Tasks

The project shall implement the following activities in accordance with applicable organizational policies and procedures.

6.4.11.3.1 Software Disposal Planning

This activity defines the strategy and prepares the plan for disposal.

- 6.4.11.3.1.1 Define and document a software disposal strategy that aligns with business, technical, and regulatory requirements.
 - 6.4.11.3.1.2 Develop and document a disposal plan that removes active support responsibilities from the operation and maintenance organizations.
 - 6.4.11.3.1.3 Include users and stakeholders in the planning activities to ensure acceptance and readiness for change.
 - 6.4.11.3.1.4 Address in the disposal plan:
 - Scheduled cessation of full or partial support.
 - Archiving of the software product, documentation, and associated logs.
 - Responsibility assignment for residual support issues.
 - Transition approach to any replacement software product.
 - Accessibility of archived copies of data.
 - 6.4.11.3.1.5 Identify disposal constraints such as health, safety, security, privacy, and environmental considerations.
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6.4.11.3.2 Software Disposal Execution

This activity executes the disposal plan and ensures proper retirement of the software.

- 6.4.11.3.2.1 Execute the software disposal plan according to the defined strategy.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.2 Notify users of the retirement schedule, replacement or upgrade options, reasons for discontinuation, and available support options.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.3 Where a new system is introduced, conduct parallel operations as needed to ensure continuity of service. Provide user training and guidance during the transition.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.4 Upon scheduled retirement, terminate operational use and archive associated development documentation, source code, databases, and operational logs.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.5 Ensure data used by or associated with the retired software product remains accessible in accordance with data protection, legal, and audit requirements.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.6 Verify that the environment is restored to an acceptable operational state after software removal.
 - 6.4.11.3.2.7 Create and preserve records of disposal actions and assess long-term impacts on the organization, stakeholders, and environment.
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Cross-References

This process interacts with the following:

- **Software Maintenance Process (6.4.10)** — for managing updates and changes prior to retirement.
- **Software Problem Resolution Process (7.2.8)** — for resolving issues discovered during disposal.
- **Information Management Process (6.3.5)** — for handling archiving and accessibility of records.
- **Configuration Management Process (6.3.4)** — for controlling baselines and ensuring proper archival.